this has occurred only to a very limited extent. India hosted the 8th BRICS Summit in Goa in October 2016, and, as is the practice, the host may invite neighbouring countries for an outreach summit. Following the cross-border attack on the Indian Army camp at Uri in Jammu and Kashmir in September of the same year, India chose to invite countries belonging to the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) (India, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Nepal, Myanmar, Thailand, and Sri Lanka) rather than those of the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC). This left out Pakistan, Afghanistan, and the Maldives, a decision seen as an attempt to isolate Islamabad.[28] It was also an indication of the importance New Delhi attaches to the Bay of Bengal region. BIMSTEC has indeed the potential to accelerate regional integration, security cooperation, and increased connectivity.[29] However, when China hosted the 9th BRICS Summit in Xiamen in September the following year, it chose to focus on international South–South co-operation along the BRICS Plus pattern, inviting the heads of state of Thailand, Mexico, Egypt, Tajikistan, and Kenya.[30]

While neither China nor India is an ASEAN member, Sino–Indian co-operation is facilitated through their participation in various ASEAN-affiliated forums and meeting places. India and China are both part of the East Asian Summit, which has held annual summits since the mid-2000s. They also meet at the highest level within the framework of the G20 grouping, which was institutionalised in full after the 2008–10 global financial crisis. India is scheduled to host the G20 meeting in 2022. In 2018, Modi, Chinese Premier Xi Jinping, and Russian President Vladimir Putin held a trilateral meeting on the sidelines of the G20 summit. Coming after a gap of 12 years, this was only the second Russia–India–China (RIC) meeting. The 2018 RIC trilateral happened shortly after another meeting – the first trilateral of Prime